

Daily Briefing

Wednesday, August 5, 2026

Calendar

No events found on your Google or Outlook calendars for today.

Newsletter Summaries

Checkpoint (Thomson Reuters) — Daily Update, Aug 5

Top stories: a new accounting standard now in effect lets colleges, hospitals, and membership groups skip complex economic forecasting when estimating unpaid tuition, patient bills, and dues. Separately, tax professionals warn that student-athletes earning NIL (name, image, likeness) income are increasingly treated as self-employed business owners, and many are unprepared for the resulting income and self-employment tax bills.

Federal news: tax specialists say the IRS is leaning more heavily on AI and data analytics for enforcement, alongside a renewed focus on complex compliance issues and expanded early-dispute-resolution and automated penalty-relief programs. Twenty-five Democratic-led states sued the Trump administration over its latest tariffs on goods from 60 trading partners, arguing they exceed the president's legal authority. A payment dispute between hospitals and Medicare Advantage insurers over prior authorizations and denials is triggering hospital cancellation letters to seniors. The PCAOB fined BDO Brazil \$300,000 for audit and quality-control failures on a 2020 telecom audit. The IRS Office of Professional Responsibility warned practitioners that unreasonable delays in client matters can trigger IRS bypass of the practitioner and possible discipline. The SEC adopted technical amendments to fund-governance rules to reflect a 2006 court decision, and Senator Warner introduced a bill targeting trading on privileged access to Trump's social media posts. No attachments were included.

Accounting Today — Daily Briefing, Aug 5

The IRS's improper-payment rate on refundable tax credits rose from 21.9% in 2024 to 26.5% in 2025, totaling roughly \$28.1 billion. On the M&A side, Ascend-affiliated firms continue expanding in California and New York: San Jose-based PP&Co acquired Ami Shah, and Mid-Atlantic leader LMC opened a new office by adding Ricky Spike's team from Ives, Sultan & Spike CPAs. Small-business weekly work hours hit a five-year high in July per Paychex data. FASAB issued new guidance on disclosure requirements for public-private partnerships. A featured opinion piece argues the October tax crunch most firms feel is self-inflicted — caused by treating July and August as downtime rather than by the deadline itself.

Bradford Tax Institute — Webinar Notice, Aug 4

"The IRS hit a preparer with \$130,000 in penalties. His client set the salary." Bradford Tax Institute is promoting a live webinar, "Make Every Client's S Corporation a Tax-Saving Machine," airing Thursday, August 6, 2026 at 2:00 PM. The pitch centers on a cautionary case where a preparer was penalized over an S-corp reasonable-salary determination set by the client rather than the preparer — underscoring the risk of not actively controlling reasonable-compensation positions for S-corp clients. No separate article content was included beyond the webinar promotion.

CPA Trendlines — Academy Webinar, Aug 4

"Succession Planning That Can't Wait," a live session with Erin Daiber of Well Balanced Accountants (12:00–2:00 PM EDT, 2 CPE, \$99). The framing: most firms have at least one partner heading toward retirement but no real transition plan. Firms that start planning 3–5 years out end up with higher firm value, more confident successors, and better client retention through the transition; firms that wait until a departure is imminent have the decisions made for them. No separate article content was included beyond the webinar promotion.

Other Important Emails

Ivy McDonald (Thomson Reuters) — "Recap and Action Items from Today's Meeting | CoCounsel Value Review." Follow-up recap thanking Dennis for meeting to discuss his practice and how CoCounsel fits his workflow.

Golf, Saturday Aug 8 — Thread with Faust Wertz and John Slattery on tee times starting 8:10 AM; Slattery has confirmed he's in.

Tasks

Due today: Take Mary Anne to Tampa General for her Moffitt procedure (Aug 5, 2026)

No overdue tasks.